KARNATAKA-FIRST | INDIA-READY

KARNATAKA POLICE MODERNISATION PROJECT

Complete Technical and Operational Reference Manual

Chapter 3

Understanding the Indian Policing Ecosystem

A practical guide to constitutional responsibilities, central institutions, national police platforms and criminal-justice coordination.

TEAM REFERENCE EDITION

Institutional • Legal • Operational • Digital • Inter-agency

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Document Control

Field	Description
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Primary purpose	Explain how State police, Union institutions, national platforms and justice-system partners relate to one another

Important status and use notice
This chapter is an educational and project-planning reference. It is not legal advice, an official government organogram, an operational order, or permission to access or exchange government data. Agency powers, data-sharing permissions, local implementation status and current operating procedures must be verified with the relevant authority before software requirements are approved.

How to Read This Chapter

Start with the constitutional division of responsibilities. Then study the major Union institutions and the national platforms that already support police work. The later sections explain how these systems connect with State police, courts, prosecution, prisons, forensic laboratories and citizens. The final sections translate this ecosystem into practical architecture and governance requirements for the Karnataka-first project.

The central design principle
The proposed project should integrate with, strengthen and improve the use of authorised existing systems. It should not create a parallel criminal-record database, duplicate national functionality or assume that a central institution directly manages everyday State police operations.

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3.1 Purpose and Learning Outcomes

Police work in India operates within a federal constitutional structure. State police organisations carry the principal responsibility for day-to-day public order and policing within their jurisdictions, while the Union Government provides national coordination, central investigative and security capabilities, standards, funding support and shared digital platforms. Courts, prosecution services, prisons and forensic institutions form part of the wider criminal-justice chain. [1][2]

For the Karnataka Police Modernisation Project, this ecosystem is not background theory. It determines which organisation owns a process, who can authorise an action, which system is the source of truth, what data may be exchanged, and where an integration must be built instead of a duplicate feature.

By the end of this chapter, every team member should be able to:

- Distinguish Union responsibilities from State police responsibilities.
- Explain the roles of MHA, NCRB, BPR&D, I4C, NIA and other major institutions.
- Describe the purpose and boundaries of CCTNS, ICJS and ERSS 112.
- Understand how police, courts, prosecution, prisons and forensic laboratories exchange information.
- Identify the questions that must be answered before designing a new module or integration.
- Recognise that system access and data sharing require legal authority, a defined purpose and audit controls.

3.2 Constitutional Foundation: Union and State Responsibilities

India is a Union of States. The Seventh Schedule to the Constitution distributes legislative subjects between the Union, States and Concurrent List. The State List includes ‘public order’ (Entry 1) and ‘police’ (Entry 2), subject to the constitutional qualifications and other Union powers. The Ministry of Home Affairs explains that State Governments have the primary duty to prevent, detect, register and investigate crime and prosecute offenders; the Union supplements State efforts through coordination, intelligence inputs, training, technical and financial support, and central capabilities. [1][2]

Layer	Primary function in the ecosystem	What it means for this project
State Government	Responsible for State public order and the State police organisation, within the Constitution and applicable laws.	Karnataka approvals, operational ownership, workflows, staffing, local policy, procurement and deployment must be State-led.
Union Government	Exercises Union subjects and statutory functions; supports States through MHA, central forces, national systems, advisories and funding schemes.	Integrations with national systems must respect the Union system's published interfaces, rules and authorised access.
Courts and constitutional institutions	Exercise independent constitutional and statutory functions, including judicial oversight and adjudication.	The software must not treat a police record as a judicial finding or automate a judicial decision.
Other States / UTs	Operate their own law-enforcement organisations and systems, subject to applicable national law and coordination arrangements.	Inter-State exchange must be designed as controlled collaboration, not unrestricted access to every State record.

3.2.1 Why this is not a simple command hierarchy

The MHA is not the routine line manager of Karnataka's police stations. Karnataka Police is part of the State's executive and administrative structure. Central agencies have their own statutory mandates and jurisdictional rules. A national database or portal may support an investigation without taking over the investigation. A central scheme may fund equipment without becoming the operational owner of the State service. These distinctions should be reflected in the system's authority model.

3.2.2 Constitutional and statutory authority must be modelled separately

The Constitution allocates legislative competence, but the authority for a particular operational act also depends on the applicable statute, rules, court orders, notifications, delegation and procedure. A software feature must therefore store or reference the legal basis and approving authority where that is relevant. A generic ‘admin’ role must never be treated as a substitute for statutory authority.

> Design rule
> Do not infer powers from an agency name, job title or technical connection. Before implementing a cross-agency action, document the legal basis, authorised requester, receiving authority, permitted data fields, purpose, retention rule and audit record.

3.3 Ministry of Home Affairs: National Policy and Coordination

The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) is the Union ministry with major responsibilities for internal security, Centre-State relations, Union Territory administration, Central Armed Police Forces, border management and other home-affairs functions. Within policing and internal security, different MHA divisions handle distinct policy, administrative, coordination and programme responsibilities. [3]

3.3.1 MHA divisions relevant to police modernisation

Institution / division	Role relevant to the ecosystem	Potential project interface
Police Modernisation Division	Deals with modernisation of State police forces, central force provisioning, police communication, police reforms and related policy / financial matters. Current MHA listings include Modernisation of Police Forces guidelines dated 6 October 2026. [4]	Scheme eligibility, equipment and infrastructure standards, procurement policy, communication and modernisation planning.
Internal Security divisions	Handle internal-security and law-and-order policy matters, coordination and related security subjects. [3]	Lawful information coordination and State-central liaison, as authorised.
Cyber and Information Security Division	Handles cybercrime and cybersecurity coordination, including administration of I4C and NATGRID. [5]	Cybercrime ecosystem coordination and government cybersecurity requirements.
Women Safety / ICJS-NCRB administration	MHA's published responsibilities include ICJS/NCRB administration and associated national systems and forensic ecosystem matters. [6]	ICJS, CCTNS-related coordination, and relevant national programme interfaces.
Disaster Management Division	Coordinates Union disaster-management functions and national response frameworks.	Defined coordination pathways for major disasters; this does not replace State incident command.

3.3.2 How MHA support reaches State police

Support may take several forms: policy advisories, centrally supported schemes, capability-building programmes, technology standards, communication coordination, intelligence sharing and deployment of central forces when lawfully requested or otherwise authorised. These mechanisms are different from routine supervision of an individual police investigation. The project team must identify the specific scheme or authority relevant to each proposed procurement or integration rather than assuming a general MHA approval is sufficient.

> Current-source note
> MHA's Police Modernisation Division page lists the Modernisation of Police Forces Guidelines dated 6 October 2026. The existence and date of the guidance are verified; project eligibility, allowable expenditure, funding shares and procurement conditions must be checked against the full operative guideline and later amendments before budgeting. [4]

3.4 State Police Organisations and National Coordination

Each State has its own police organisation, administrative arrangements, jurisdictional map, specialised units and technology environment. State police organisations are responsible for everyday policing within their territorial and statutory remit. National programmes support common data formats, coordination and inter-operability, but do not erase differences in State laws, procedures, administrative structures or local operating conditions. [2]

3.4.1 State-level responsibilities

- Law and order, preventive policing, public safety and response to local incidents.
- Registration and investigation of offences by authorised officers under applicable law.
- Management of police stations, district and commissionerate operations, specialist wings and field personnel.
- State-level citizen services, traffic enforcement, community policing and local safety initiatives.
- Maintaining State records and submitting information through national systems where required.
- Coordinating with other States, Union agencies, courts, prosecution and forensic institutions through lawful channels.

3.4.2 Karnataka as the first implementation environment

The proposed programme should start by mapping Karnataka's current organisational and system landscape: the Home Department, Karnataka Police headquarters, ranges, districts, commissionerates, police stations, specialised units, State Data Centre arrangements, existing portals and control-room infrastructure. This map must be validated with official departmental organograms and system owners. Chapter 2 describes the State police organisation; this chapter explains how it connects outward to the national ecosystem.

3.4.3 National coordination is not unrestricted national access

A State officer may need to send a case referral, search an authorised national record, request forensic support or coordinate with another State. Each activity is a separate transaction with its own purpose, access rights and evidentiary implications. Cross-State visibility should be role-based, logged and constrained to the specific case, task or statutory purpose.

3.5 National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)

The National Crime Records Bureau was established under the Ministry of Home Affairs in 1986. MHA describes NCRB as a national repository of information on crime and criminals, and as the body responsible for collecting, compiling and analysing national crime statistics. It also has a central role in the country's police information-technology ecosystem, including CCTNS and ICJS implementation. [7][8]

3.5.1 Main functions

- National crime and criminal information systems and related data standards.
- Compilation and publication of national crime statistics and other reference datasets.
- Coordination and monitoring of CCTNS implementation and national-level data replication.
- Nodal implementation responsibility for ICJS, working with the National Informatics Centre (NIC) as technology partner. [6]
- Support to police organisations for information technology, records, fingerprints, training and digital capability, as described in official portals.

3.5.2 What NCRB is not

NCRB is not the police station that receives a local complaint, the investigating officer for an ordinary State case, or a court deciding guilt. Its national information systems make authorised search and data exchange possible. The underlying investigation and operational action remain with the legally competent law-enforcement agency unless a separate statutory transfer or central-agency mandate applies.

3.5.3 Implications for our project

Treat NCRB-managed platforms as national systems of record or national services where applicable. The project should identify published APIs, authorised integration procedures, common master codes, record identifiers and data-sharing rules. Never scrape, mirror or bulk-copy a national database as a shortcut. If direct integration is unavailable, define an authorised manual or secure referral process and record the limitation.

3.6 Bureau of Police Research and Development (BPR&D)

BPR&D was established in 1970 under MHA with a mandate that includes systematic study of policing challenges, research, application of science and technology, training policy, modernisation advice and impact assessment. Its official mandate includes reviewing police training needs, standardising training arrangements, developing learning material and evaluating modernisation technologies and schemes. [9][10]

3.6.1 Research and policy contribution

BPR&D can provide a research and standards reference for the project: policing practices, operational procedures, equipment evaluation, training needs, model manuals, research studies and lessons from other jurisdictions. It should be treated as a source of expert guidance and capability-building, not as the day-to-day system owner for Karnataka Police.

3.6.2 Modernisation and technology evaluation

BPR&D's Modernisation Division describes a role in reviewing police equipment, liaising with laboratories and scientific organisations, advising MHA on technology and assessing modernisation schemes. [10] This matters for procurement: a technology should be selected for a demonstrated operational need, field suitability, lifecycle cost, training burden, interoperability, security and measurable benefit - not simply because it is new.

3.6.3 Training and change management

A police technology project is also a workforce and process-change project. The project should provide role-specific training, refresher courses, supervisor training, operating manuals, simulation exercises and feedback loops. BPR&D's training mandate makes it a relevant national reference point when designing a training strategy, while Karnataka training institutions and departmental authorities remain central to actual rollout.

3.7 Crime and Criminal Tracking Network and Systems (CCTNS)

CCTNS is the national police information system programme intended to connect police stations through common application software and standardised records. MHA describes the project as supporting computerisation of police processes, investigation, analytics, research, policy-making and citizen services. [6]

3.7.1 What CCTNS supports

- Digitisation of police processes and records, including complaints, FIRs, investigation details, charge sheets and other station records.
- Search of authorised crime, criminal and property-related information at State and national levels.
- Standardised Integrated Investigation Forms and master codes for States, districts, police stations, Acts and sections.
- Replication of State Data Centre records to the National Data Centre in near real time, as stated by MHA.
- Citizen-facing services through State portals and the national Digital Police / citizen service portal. [8]

3.7.2 Publicly reported CCTNS coverage snapshot

A Ministry of Home Affairs reply published by the Press Information Bureau on 11 March 2026 reported that, as of 1 February 2026, all 17,798 police stations listed nationally were using CCTNS. The annexure listed Karnataka at 1,103 of 1,103 police stations, with national data replication marked ‘Yes’. [8]

Measure	Reported position	Interpretation
India	17,798 of 17,798 police stations listed as using CCTNS	Nationwide deployment is reported; this is not a complete assessment of usage quality or uptime.
Karnataka	1,103 of 1,103 police stations listed; NDC replication marked Yes	Karnataka already has a national police-system footprint that the project must account for.
Data format	Standardised Integrated Investigation Forms and master codes are in use	Interoperability and code consistency are important design constraints.

Important interpretation
‘All police stations are using CCTNS’ is a deployment and usage statement in the cited parliamentary reply. It does not prove that every feature is used equally, that every record is complete, that data is error-free, that all workflows are integrated, or that every user has reliable connectivity. These must be assessed with departmental evidence.

3.7.3 Conceptual CCTNS data path



Conceptual workflow - actual routing, ownership and legal authority depend on the incident and applicable procedure.

This is a simplified representation of the published model. It is not a system deployment diagram or a promise that every API or data element is available to the project. The production integration design must be agreed with the system owner.

3.7.4 What the project should do around CCTNS

- Map current State CCTNS workflows and identify actual pain points before proposing new functionality.
- Avoid creating a duplicate FIR, complaint or criminal-record repository that conflicts with the authorised source system.
- Use approved identifiers and master codes where integration rules require them.
- Build workflow assistance, citizen experience improvements, operational dashboards or secure connectors only where the system owner and legal authority approve.
- Define reconciliation, error handling, audit and data-quality controls for any synchronised field.

3.8 Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System (ICJS)

ICJS is designed to integrate the principal information systems used by the criminal-justice process. MHA identifies five pillars: police through CCTNS, courts through e-Courts, prisons through e-Prisons, forensic laboratories through e-Forensics and prosecution through e-Prosecution. NCRB is the nodal implementation agency, with NIC as technology partner; interlinked data flow is based on a data-sharing matrix approved by the Supreme Court's e-Committee. [6]

3.8.1 The five pillars

Pillar	System / institution	Typical information relationship
Police	CCTNS and State police systems	FIR, investigation, arrest, seizure, witness, case and police report information, subject to law and approved sharing.
Courts	e-Courts / court information systems	Case registration, filings, hearing and judicial order information.
Prisons	e-Prisons	Custody, admission, prisoner identity, movement and other prison-management information.
Forensics	e-Forensics / forensic laboratories	Requests for examination, sample tracking, laboratory status and forensic reports.
Prosecution	e-Prosecution	Legal scrutiny, prosecution case preparation, advice, filings and case progress.

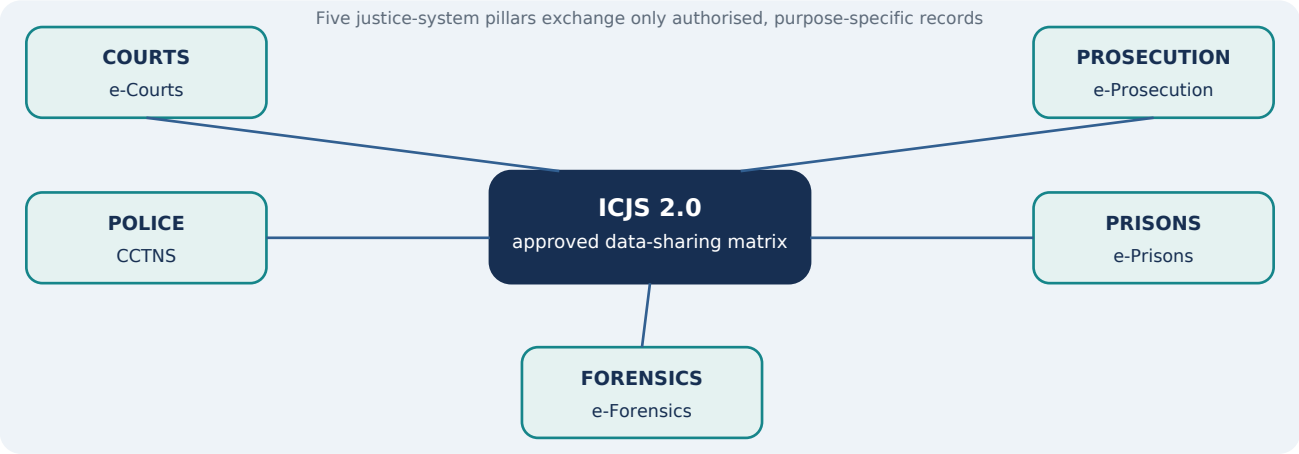


Figure 3.1 - Conceptual view of the five ICJS pillars. The lines represent authorised interoperability, not unrestricted mutual access.

3.8.2 One Data, One Entry: what it means

The policy objective is to reduce repeated entry of the same information across disconnected systems and to make relevant information available to the next authorised institution. It does not mean that all agencies should write to a single unrestricted database. Each agency continues to have its own purpose, legal responsibilities, records and access controls. The approved data-sharing matrix governs what is shared between pillars. [6]

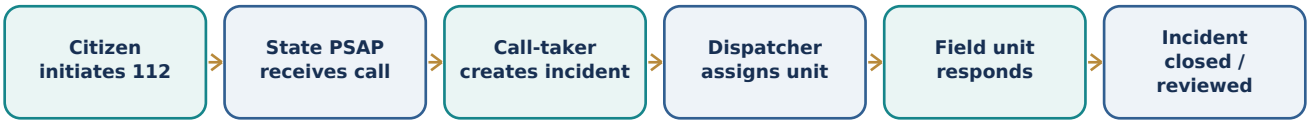
3.8.3 Why ICJS matters to the project

- A police case is not complete at the police station; it may involve prosecutors, forensic laboratories, courts and prisons.
- Case identifiers and party identifiers need reliable mapping across systems, while preserving each system's record of origin.
- A status shown in one module should be labelled with its source and last synchronisation time.
- Integration failures must create visible exceptions and reconciliation tasks, not silently drop a record.
- Evidence and court-facing documents require integrity, version control, access history and lawful disclosure controls.

3.9 Emergency Response Support System (ERSS) - 112

ERSS-112 is MHA's nationwide, unified emergency-response framework. MHA describes a State-centric system operating through a Public Safety Answering Point (PSAP). It can receive distress information through multiple channels, route actionable incidents to police, health, fire, disaster, women, children and railway response services, and support dispatch through computer-aided dispatch, GIS terminals, emergency response units and mobile data terminals. The MHA page was updated on 11 November 2026. [11]

3.9.1 Conceptual emergency workflow



Conceptual workflow - actual routing, ownership and legal authority depend on the incident and applicable procedure.

Figure 3.2 - Simplified emergency workflow. A real incident may involve more than one response agency, multiple updates and escalation steps.

3.9.2 Channels and dispatch components

The MHA ERSS description lists voice call, SMS, SOS, email, web request, chatbot, media crawler, IoT-based signals, WhatsApp and external signals as possible input channels. It describes call-taking, dispatcher hand-off, computer-aided dispatch, GIS-based terminals, tracking and communication with emergency response units. The existence of a national framework does not by itself establish the exact channel availability, integrations, service levels or equipment in every State. Those details must be verified for Karnataka. [11]

3.9.3 Project boundaries

- Do not assume that a new citizen app can replace the 112 emergency channel.
- Any integration with Karnataka's ERSS operations must be authorised by the designated State system owner.
- The system should distinguish emergency incidents from ordinary complaints and administrative requests.
- Incident location, caller information and responder location are sensitive operational data and require strict access, retention and audit controls.
- When ERSS is unavailable, approved fallback communication and manual logging procedures must remain available.

3.10 Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) and National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal

I4C is an MHA initiative for coordinated and comprehensive action against cybercrime. MHA records that I4C became an attached office of the Ministry on 1 July 2024. The National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP) gives citizens a channel to report cybercrime complaints. I4C supports coordination, capacity building, awareness, cybercrime analytics and specialised national capabilities. [5][12]

3.10.1 Important I4C ecosystem functions

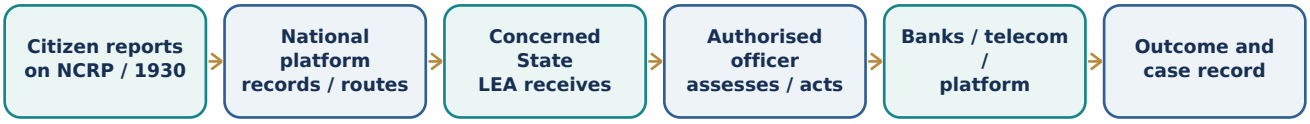
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal for online reporting by citizens.
- Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting and Management System and helpline 1930 for rapid reporting of financial cyber fraud.
- Samanvaya as a coordination, data repository and analytics platform for law-enforcement agencies.
- Joint Cybercrime Coordination Teams and other multi-jurisdiction coordination arrangements.
- Technical support, training, research and information-sharing across law-enforcement and stakeholder organisations. [12][13]

3.10.2 Who investigates a reported cybercrime?

The national portal is a reporting and coordination channel. The responsible State or Union Territory law-enforcement agency handles the complaint and subsequent action under applicable law. An official government portal disclaimer further states that I4C/NCRP does not itself have authority to place, freeze or unfreeze bank-account liens; those actions belong to competent law-enforcement agencies under law. [13][21]

> Critical workflow distinction
> A cybercrime report submitted online is not automatically the same thing as a registered FIR, a proven offence, a frozen account or a completed investigation. The receiving authority must classify, verify, register and act according to applicable law and procedure.

3.10.3 Cybercrime workflow for Karnataka



Conceptual workflow - actual routing, ownership and legal authority depend on the incident and applicable procedure.

Figure 3.3 - Conceptual cybercrime reporting and coordination path. Exact routing and action depend on complaint type, jurisdiction, law and agency procedure.

3.10.4 Project integration requirements

The project should assess whether existing Karnataka cybercrime workflows already consume NCRP, 1930, Samanvaya or other authorised I4C information. A new module should add value through local case workflow, escalation, evidence organisation, task tracking or analytics only if it does not duplicate the national platform. All financial-fraud response integrations need time-sensitive escalation design, clear ownership and verifiable status updates.

3.11 National Investigation Agency (NIA)

The NIA was established under the National Investigation Agency Act, 2008 as a central investigative agency for offences with national-security and other statutory significance. Its official description identifies it as India's central counter-terrorism law-enforcement agency and explains that the NIA Act provides the framework for taking up specific cases under specified Acts. [14][15]

3.11.1 Relationship with State police

NIA is not a replacement for local police. State police may be the first responders and may undertake initial or parallel action as permitted by law. When a case is taken up by NIA under the statutory process, investigative responsibility and coordination follow the NIA Act and applicable directions. The software must not assume automatic transfer simply because a case category appears serious or has a national dimension.

3.11.2 Implications for case management

- Support a controlled inter-agency referral or handover workflow with an explicit legal basis and approval record.
- Preserve original State records, timestamps, chain of custody and prior access history.
- Define a secure mechanism to share only the documents and metadata authorised for the referral.
- Record the receiving agency, case reference, transfer status, acknowledgement and return correspondence.
- Restrict national-security or sensitive case material to specifically authorised personnel.

3.12 Other Central Investigative and Enforcement Agencies

Several Union agencies have specialised statutory or administrative mandates. They are not interchangeable with State police, and their jurisdiction cannot be inferred from a software label. The project need not integrate with every agency at launch; it should document possible interaction points and establish them only through authorised agreements.

3.12.1 Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)

The CBI derives its investigative powers primarily through the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946 and related legal arrangements. The Act's framework includes provisions for extension of jurisdiction to areas in States, including the role of State consent under Section 6. The exact position for any case depends on the statute, applicable notifications, consent, court orders and case-specific facts. [16][17]

Project implication: treat a CBI matter as an external-agency case or controlled referral, not as a normal Karnataka Police assignment. Only expose information that is specifically authorised and logged.

3.12.2 Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)

NCB is the national nodal agency for coordination and enforcement against illicit trafficking in narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances under the NDPS framework. MHA describes the Bureau as coordinating with ministries, State and Central enforcement agencies, while the national NCORD mechanism supports inter-agency coordination. [18]

Project implication: drug-related work may involve State police, NCB, customs and other enforcement bodies. A shared case or intelligence reference must distinguish a local police investigation from an NCB-led or coordinated operation.

3.12.3 Intelligence Bureau and other security bodies

The Intelligence Bureau is a central intelligence organisation. Intelligence products, sources and operational information are subject to special handling and authorised channels. A public-facing or general police dashboard must not expose source identities, raw intelligence or national-security material. Any proposed exchange must be approved by the competent agency and protected by purpose limitation, compartmentalised access and audit.

3.13 Central Armed Police Forces and State Police

Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) are Union forces with defined roles in internal security, border guarding, critical infrastructure security and support to civil authorities, depending on the force and the deployment order. Examples include the CRPF, BSF, CISF, ITBP and SSB. They are distinct from the ordinary State police organisation. MHA's Police Modernisation Division also handles provisioning matters for CAPFs as well as State police modernisation policy. [4]

3.13.1 Practical distinction

State police	Central armed police forces
Operate as the State's principal police organisation for routine local policing, crime registration and investigation under applicable law.	Operate under Union command structures and force-specific mandates; may be deployed for specified security or support duties.
Use State organisational hierarchy, police stations, districts, commissionerates and specialist units.	Use central force command, battalion / sector structures and deployment instructions.
Maintain local jurisdictional and case-management responsibilities, subject to any lawful transfer or special statutory process.	Do not automatically become the local police station or investigate every ordinary local offence merely by being present.

3.13.2 System-design implication

Where joint operations are authorised, the system should record the lead agency, supporting agency, operational commander, tasking authority, incident identifier, deployment period, permitted information set and post-operation handover. Avoid giving a generic CAPF login access to all State police records.

3.14 Police Communication Coordination: DCPW

The Directorate of Coordination Police Wireless (DCPW) is a subordinate organisation under MHA. Its official description says it coordinates the development and establishment of the Police Telecommunication Network across the country and advises MHA on police telecommunication matters. It describes a network of inter-State Police Wireless Stations connecting State and Union Territory capitals. [19]

For the project, communication infrastructure is not just a network connection. It includes radio and voice systems, secure data links, control-room connectivity, field devices, backup power, availability, spectrum and interoperability considerations. Digital applications should be designed to tolerate weak or interrupted connectivity and to provide approved fallback procedures.

3.14.1 Design considerations

- Separate routine office traffic from emergency and operational communications where required by policy.
- Design offline and delayed-sync workflows for field users.
- Protect command and dispatch messages with identity, timestamp, acknowledgement and audit records.
- Plan redundancy for district and State control-room links.
- Use approved communication equipment and network standards; do not create unofficial radio or interception capabilities.

3.15 Other National Police Information Systems

CCTNS and ICJS are not the only national information systems relevant to policing. MHA's published responsibilities reference systems and databases such as the National Automated Fingerprint Identification System (NAFIS), Investigation Tracking System for Sexual Offences (ITSSO), National Integrated Database on Arrested Narco-Offenders (NIDAAN), National Database on Sexual Offenders (NDSO), and related systems. [20]

System / name	High-level purpose	Project design caution
NAFIS	National fingerprint identification and search capability.	Biometric use is highly sensitive; access, purpose, quality, retention and audit must follow governing rules.
ITSSO	Investigation tracking for specified sexual-offence cases.	Apply special confidentiality, victim-protection and statutory workflow controls.
NIDAAN	National database concerning arrested narco-offenders.	A record of arrest is not proof of guilt; distinguish arrest, charge, conviction and acquittal.
NDSO	National database of sexual offenders.	Access and disclosure must be tightly controlled; public disclosure should not be inferred.
Digital Police / citizen services	National and State portals for selected police search and citizen services.	Avoid duplicating an existing citizen service without identifying a gap and obtaining system-owner approval.

3.15.1 A database name is not an integration specification

Before designing a connector, the team must obtain the system's current owner, purpose, legal basis, API documentation, authentication model, approved data fields, rate limits, logging requirements, service levels, test environment and support process. Public descriptions identify a programme; they do not authorise access.

3.16 Courts, Prosecution, Forensics and Prisons: The Wider Justice Chain

Police activity connects to institutions that operate independently and perform different functions. The court adjudicates; the prosecution presents the State's case; forensic laboratories conduct scientific examinations; prisons manage persons committed to custody under lawful authority. ICJS aims to support appropriate information exchange among these pillars. [6]

3.16.1 Why each institution needs its own record

- The police record documents complaint, investigation, arrest, seizure, witness and case actions.
- The forensic record documents laboratory receipt, examination method, findings, limitations and reporting.
- The prosecution record documents legal scrutiny, advice, filing and prosecution progress.
- The court record documents filings, orders, hearings, judicial decisions and case disposal.
- The prison record documents admission, custody, movements, release and prison administration.

3.16.2 Keep process status and legal status distinct

A police case marked ‘charge sheet submitted’ is not the same as a case decided by a court. An accused person is not the same as a convicted person. A forensic report is an expert output, not an automatic conclusion of guilt. A bail order or custody event must be represented from the authoritative source and not inferred from an officer's informal note. Every external status should carry its source, timestamp and synchronisation status.

> Data modelling rule
> Use separate entities and status histories for complaint, FIR, investigation, accused person, arrest, evidence item, forensic request, prosecution file, court case, order and custody event. Do not compress the entire justice lifecycle into one editable ‘case status’ field.

3.17 Modernisation Schemes, Standards and Capacity Building

The Union Government supplements State modernisation through policy, grants or assistance schemes, police communication coordination, training resources and central technical capabilities. MHA's Police Modernisation Division lists the modernisation guidelines currently published on its website, including guidelines dated 6 October 2026. BPR&D contributes research, technology evaluation, training and modernisation advice. [4][9][10]

3.17.1 What a modernisation scheme does - and does not do

A scheme may define eligible components, planning requirements, State proposals, procurement and reporting conditions. It does not automatically approve a particular vendor, software architecture, data-sharing arrangement or operational process. The State must follow the current scheme text, financial rules, procurement law, technical standards and internal approval mechanisms.

3.17.2 Project funding and procurement workstream

- Identify the current scheme and its operative guideline version.
- Map each proposed cost to an eligible component and a measurable capability gap.
- Separate capital costs from recurring costs, maintenance, licences, connectivity and training.
- Check procurement preference, cybersecurity, hosting, data location and audit requirements.
- Define vendor exit, data portability, source-code / escrow arrangements where appropriate, and transition support.

- Report outcomes in operational terms rather than only counting equipment delivered.

3.18 How Inter-Agency Coordination Works in Practice

The same incident may involve several institutions, but not all institutions need all the information. The coordination mechanism should be driven by the operational purpose and legal authority. Four common patterns are: referral, information lookup, shared workflow and multi-agency response.

Pattern	Example	Minimum system controls
Referral	A State police unit refers a matter to a central agency or another State.	Legal basis, authorised sender, receiving agency, document manifest, acknowledgement, transfer time and access log.
Authorised lookup	An investigating officer searches a national fingerprint or criminal-record service.	User role, case or purpose reference, query reason, permitted result fields, access log and misuse review.
Shared workflow	Police, prosecution and forensic laboratory coordinate a case milestone.	Case correlation identifier, ownership of each task, deadlines, status provenance, document integrity and exception handling.
Multi-agency incident	A major emergency involves police, fire, health and disaster responders.	Lead incident commander, agency-specific tasks, minimum necessary incident data, acknowledgement, update history and closure review.

3.18.1 Example: a multi-State cyber-enabled financial fraud

A citizen reports suspected financial fraud through an authorised reporting channel. The report is routed to the relevant State or Union Territory law-enforcement agency. The investigating agency may need to coordinate with banks, payment intermediaries, telecom operators, platforms and other States. I4C can support national coordination and analytics, while statutory investigation and coercive action remain with competent law-enforcement authorities. The system must retain a clear event history showing who requested what, from whom, under which authority, and what response was received. [12][13]

3.18.2 Example: a criminal case moving through the justice chain

Police register and investigate a case, preserve evidence and prepare the police report. Forensic requests and reports may be exchanged with a laboratory; prosecution may scrutinise case material; the court records filings and judicial orders; prison systems may receive custody or sentence information where legally required. ICJS supports interoperability across these pillars, but each institution remains responsible for its own records and decisions. [6]

3.19 Data Sharing, Identity and Governance Across Agencies

Interoperability is a governance problem as much as a technology problem. The existence of a network connection or API does not itself create a legal right to access the data. A trustworthy design must establish who owns the record, who may request it, why it is needed, which fields may be disclosed, how it is protected and when it must be deleted or archived.

3.19.1 Minimum data-sharing agreement checklist

- Participating agencies and named system owners.
- Statutory or other lawful basis for each data exchange.
- Defined purposes and permitted use cases.
- Data fields, classification and quality requirements.
- Identity, authentication and role / attribute-based authorisation.

- Approval and escalation path for exceptional access.
- Transport security, encryption, key management and endpoint control.
- Audit logging, independent review and misuse reporting.
- Retention, correction, archival and deletion responsibilities.
- Incident response, breach reporting, service levels and exit arrangements.

3.19.2 Record provenance and trust

Every imported or synchronised record should preserve its source agency, source identifier, creation timestamp, last-updated timestamp, retrieval time, data classification, legal purpose and synchronisation result. If a record is corrected by its source agency, the receiving system should preserve a traceable history rather than silently overwrite an earlier value. A failed synchronisation must be visible to an authorised operator.

3.19.3 Least privilege and compartmentalisation

Access should be limited by role, unit, jurisdiction, case assignment, purpose and data sensitivity. A district dashboard may show aggregate counts without exposing victim names. A technical administrator should not automatically see case contents. A contractor should not receive operational data merely because the contractor supports the application. Break-glass access, where authorised, must be exceptional, time-limited, justified and reviewed.

3.20 What This Means for the Karnataka Police Modernisation Project

The project should be designed as a State capability layer that works with the national ecosystem. It should first map the current systems, owners, approved workflows and data exchanges in Karnataka. Only then should it propose new features, replacement components or integrations.

3.20.1 Recommended architecture posture

Architectural decision	Recommended posture	Reason
Core police records	Use and integrate with authorised CCTNS processes; do not silently create a parallel record of truth.	Avoid conflicting FIR / investigation records and costly duplication.
Justice-system exchanges	Design around ICJS and its approved sharing matrix; verify State-specific readiness and current interfaces.	Respect the national interoperability model and each pillar's ownership.
Emergency response	Treat ERSS 112 as an existing national framework and verify Karnataka's current deployment / owner before designing integration.	Avoid fragmented emergency call-taking and dispatch.
Cybercrime	Complement NCRP / I4C and the competent State LEA workflow.	Keep reporting, coordination and investigation roles distinct.
Central agencies	Implement referrals and authorised exchanges only where supported by a legal basis and operational agreement.	Prevent unauthorised cross-agency access.
Analytics	Prefer aggregated, quality-checked, auditable reporting; keep consequential decisions with authorised humans.	Improve management without creating opaque automated policing decisions.
National expansion	Use configuration-driven State variations with common identifiers and API contracts.	Support reuse without assuming every State has identical law, units or process.

3.20.2 Questions to answer before implementation

- Who is the official State owner for each existing system: CCTNS, ERSS 112, State citizen portal, cybercrime workflows and police communications?
- Which features and services are already deployed in Karnataka, and how are they actually used at station, district and headquarters levels?
- What APIs, secure gateways, data-sharing matrices and technical documentation are officially available?
- Which record is authoritative for each data element, and how are corrections synchronised?
- Which external agencies may receive or provide information for each process, and under what authority?
- What service levels, fallback procedures and escalation paths apply when a national platform is unavailable?
- Which data can be used for analytics, and which data must remain restricted or excluded?
- What evidence is required to demonstrate that an integration improves outcomes rather than simply increasing data movement?

> Recommended next project artefact
> Create a National System Interface Register before writing module-level FSDs. For every system, record the owner, function, Karnataka implementation status, source-of-truth status, legal basis, data classes, integration method, API/documentation status, service levels, dependencies, approval authority and open questions.

3.21 Chapter Summary

The Indian policing ecosystem is a network of State police organisations, Union institutions, central investigative and security agencies, national digital platforms and independent criminal-justice institutions. The Constitution gives States the primary responsibility for public order and police, while the Union supports national security, coordination, modernisation, communication, central capabilities and shared services. [1][2]

NCRB, CCTNS and ICJS are especially important to the proposed project. CCTNS is already reported as deployed across all listed Karnataka police stations as of 1 February 2026. ICJS connects police, courts, prisons, prosecution and forensic systems through approved data-sharing arrangements. ERSS 112 provides a national emergency-response framework. I4C supports cybercrime coordination, while State law-enforcement agencies remain responsible for investigation and action within their jurisdiction. [6][8][11][13]

The practical conclusion is straightforward: the Karnataka project must be integration-aware, legally grounded, source-of-truth conscious and designed around real operational workflows. Technology should connect institutions where authorised, reduce friction, improve service quality and strengthen accountability - not create a parallel government system.

> Takeaway for every team member
> Before building a feature, ask: Which institution owns this process? Which existing system already supports it? Who has legal authority? What is the authoritative record? What data is permitted to move? How will we prove the exchange is secure, useful and auditable?

3.22 Key Terms and Abbreviations

Term	Meaning
BPR&D	Bureau of Police Research and Development
CAPF	Central Armed Police Force
CBI	Central Bureau of Investigation
CCTNS	Crime and Criminal Tracking Network and Systems
DCPW	Directorate of Coordination Police Wireless
ERSS	Emergency Response Support System
I4C	Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre
ICJS	Inter-Operable Criminal Justice System
LEA	Law Enforcement Agency
MHA	Ministry of Home Affairs
NCRB	National Crime Records Bureau
NCRP	National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal
NIA	National Investigation Agency
NIC	National Informatics Centre
NAFIS	National Automated Fingerprint Identification System
NCB	Narcotics Control Bureau
PSAP	Public Safety Answering Point
SDC	State Data Centre
UT	Union Territory

3.23 Sources and Further Reading

The following official and primary sources were used for the factual descriptions in this chapter. Web pages and scheme documents can change; reviewers should verify the operative version before relying on them for procurement, legal interpretation or system design. Accessed 12 November 2026.

[1] Constitution of India, Seventh Schedule and Articles 246 / 355.
India Code - official Constitution text.

[2] Ministry of Home Affairs - Law and Order.
Explains State responsibility for police and public order and Union support.

[3] Ministry of Home Affairs - Departments and Internal Security responsibilities.
Overview of MHA departmental responsibilities.

[4] MHA - Police Modernisation Division.
Division responsibilities and current listed modernisation guidelines.

[5] MHA - Cyber and Information Security Division.
I4C administration and cyber-security coordination.

[6] MHA - ICJS / NCRB Administration.
ICJS pillars, NCRB nodal role, NIC partnership and data-sharing matrix.

[7] MHA - Our Organisations: National Crime Records Bureau.
NCRB establishment and national crime records role.

[8] Press Information Bureau / MHA - CCTNS Operational Police Stations, 11 March 2026.
National and Karnataka CCTNS station coverage as of 1 February 2026.

[9] BPR&D - Mandate.
Training policy, institutional training and standardisation mandate.

[10] BPR&D - Modernisation.
Police technology, equipment review and modernisation impact assessment.

[11] MHA - Emergency Response Support System (ERSS) 112.
State PSAP, channels, dispatch, GIS and emergency-response units; page updated 11 November 2026.

[12] MHA - Cyber and Information Security Division / I4C.
I4C status and national cybercrime coordination.

[13] National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal - FAQ and official portal material.
Citizen reporting and cybercrime complaint channel.

[14] National Investigation Agency - About NIA.
NIA mandate and statutory background.

[15] National Investigation Agency - NIA Act.
NIA Act and 2019 amendment references.

[16] India Code - Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946.
Statutory framework for DSPE / CBI investigative jurisdiction.

[17] Department of Personnel and Training - Annual Report 2024-25, CBI chapter.
Official description of CBI evolution and institutional position.

[18] Narcotics Control Bureau - official website.
NCB mandate, NDPS enforcement and coordination with State and Central agencies.

[19] Directorate of Coordination Police Wireless - About DCPW.
Police telecommunication coordination mandate.

[20] MHA - Women Safety Division / ICJS-NCRB Administration.
Lists national databases and related forensic / justice-system responsibilities.

[21] Cyber Police Portal - National Cyber Reporting Platform disclaimer.
Clarifies the distinction between national reporting / coordination and action by competent State or UT law-enforcement agencies.

Research limitation
Public sources do not reveal all Karnataka-specific interface specifications, data-sharing agreements, system uptime, local operating procedures or access-control rules. These are open research items for formal departmental consultation. The project must not infer authorisation from a public website or from the existence of a national platform.